

Making connections

There are a number of websites and applications available these days where one can communicate informally, find people, and share similar interests. These platforms allow users to connect directly with others based on their groups, interests, and location. For most of these websites, users have to follow a simple online registration process and create a user profile indicating their details.



Blogging

An online personal journal, a blog is used for recording and sharing opinions, stories, articles, and links on the web.

Video sharing

This involves publishing videos in order to share them. It also allows users to embed media in a blog or social networking post.

Crowdsourcing

This process entails obtaining services, funding, ideas, or content by seeking small contributions from a large group of people online.

HINTS AND TIPS

Pros and cons of online communication

While having a variety of methods for communication can contribute to an increase in the speed and quantity of interpersonal communication, it can also lead to misinterpretation and other negative effects.

Advantages

- **Flexibility:** accessible 24/7, from any location, as long as there is an internet connection
- **Documented:** unlike verbal communication, online communication is archived and can be revisited anytime
- **Easier to give opinion:** people who usually don't speak out in real-life situations can say what they want without interruption
- **Community:** facilitates the creation of a community irrespective of geographical distance

Disadvantages

- **Security threats:** information can be destroyed or stolen, either through a virus or hacking
- **Information overload:** the volume of information online can sometimes make it hard to focus and be heard
- **Misinterpretation:** as it is non-verbal, online communication lacks the interpersonal context that can help make meaning clear
- **Connectivity issues:** communicating online requires constant internet access – which is not always possible

Microblogging

This involves posting very short entries or updates on a social networking site. Microblogging sites allow users to subscribe to other users' content, send messages directly, and reply publicly or privately.

Photo sharing

These websites and applications allow users to publish their digital photos. These can be shared with others either publicly or privately.

